

The European Union is playing a double game

The West wants to use Armenia as a springboard to consolidate its position in the region

The European Union's civilian monitoring mission, which has been operating for more than three years, is further strengthening its position in Armenia. Supposedly, the mission monitors the conditional Azerbaijani-Armenian border. In reality, no one knows what the civilian monitoring mission does except for itself.

Sometimes we see them observing our borders with binoculars or lining up like a wedding caravan on the territory of Armenia and going somewhere. That is why they rightly call the mission "binocular diplomacy." Observations show that the European Union is trying to prove its presence in the South Caucasus with the civilian observation mission it has created.

It should be noted that the EU civilian monitoring mission began operating in December 2022. The decision on its establishment and formation was made in October of that year. But it was not a decision, but an agreement. In October of that year, Azerbaijani President Ilham Aliyev met with Armenian Prime Minister Nikol Pashinyan in Prague. The meeting was also attended by EU Council President Charles Michel and French President Emmanuel Macron. This mission was also created at Macron's initiative. Although Azerbaijan did not object to the monitoring institute, it did not agree to its activities on the conditional border.

The ambassadors of the European Union member states in Brussels have unfortunately agreed to extend the mandate of the observer mission on the Armenian side of the Armenia-Azerbaijan conditional border for another two years - until February 19, 2027. The decision is expected to be approved at a meeting of the European Union foreign ministers in the coming days. Thus, the period of stay of the EU observation mission in the region is being extended without the consent of official Baku and other regional countries. What is interesting and surprising is that the composition of the European Union civilian mission consists not of people from the humanitarian sphere, but of former military personnel and those serving in the structures of intelligence agencies. As you can see, despite its civilian name, its purpose is to carry out an intelligence mission. The members of the mission collect intelligence information about Azerbaijani positions and the areas of deployment of units through "binocular diplomacy" and transmit it to the Armenian headquarters.

The extension of the European Union's mission in Armenia does not serve peace and security, but only creates tension on the conditional border. What is worse is that Brussels is planning to militarize this civilian mission. The expansion of the mission's mandate will eventually lead to its transformation into a full-fledged military representation. The units to be militarized are planned to be deployed along the Armenian-Turkish and Armenian-Iranian borders. The main goal of taking this step is

to create favorable conditions for the EU's presence as a military factor in the region by using Armenia as a bridgehead. In fact, the European Union's civilian observation mission in Armenia is actually operating in the region in violation of international norms.

Therefore, from the very beginning, when this issue was raised, official Baku did not accept the existence of observers and stated that there was no need for their activities. It brought to the attention of international organizations that the mission would not be of any use. Because there is experience. It is known that during the years of the Armenian occupation, an institution called the OSCE Monitoring Group operated. The main task of this institution was to monitor the maintenance of the ceasefire on the line of contact of the troops. However, from the very first days, this group did not fulfill its duty, taking a pro-Armenian position. For many years, the OSCE Minsk Group only tried to legalize the occupation. Now there is absolutely no need to create such an observation mission and send it to the region. However, the European Union, which serves the Armenian lobby, is trying to continue this mission.

Azerbaijani President Ilham Aliyev touched upon this issue in an interview with local television channels on January 7 and stated: "It is difficult to say how our relations with the European Commission will develop. But I must say that last year was a year full of disappointment. So, it was last year that the European Union unequivocally sided with Armenia in the normalization process. There are many facts that you know well. Of course, the extension of the so-called European Union monitoring mission did not strengthen trust, but rather undermined it. After all, when we demanded that this be agreed with us, we were not proceeding from any high ambitions, we simply wanted the creation of this mission itself and its dispatch to our border to be agreed with us, with me personally in Prague in October 2022. If at that time we agreed that it would be for two months and consist of 40 people, then this is how it should have been. When I reach an agreement, even if it is just a word, I always adhere to these agreements. But in such a situation, Europe considered that they would not fulfill these agreements. "They have the right to violate it. Then, without any notice or agreement with us, they not only extended the duration of this mission, increased its number, but also essentially broke trust by inviting a country that is not a member of the European Union."

The head of state continued: "Then, as they say, these shameful demonstrations with binoculars, they put on paramilitary uniforms and boots and go there like some kind of fighters. I don't want to show how quickly they will run away from there, if someone accidentally enters the territory of Azerbaijan, then they will just see how their hands itch. Therefore, we told them to stop the binocular show, they are already walking around without binoculars, as they say. Although recently, the president of a European country demonstrated such indecent behavior as watching Azerbaijan with binoculars. Didn't he see these things a week ago when he was here in Baku and asked to meet with me? If he wanted to look, I would have sent him to Karabakh, he would have looked at the mountains. Do you understand, this is already a demonstration. This is not a simple matter. This is an attitude. You are looking at the enemy with binoculars. If you have such an attitude towards Azerbaijan, then how can we have an attitude? I still "I'm not talking about the destructive role of the

former High Representative for Foreign Affairs. There are other issues as well. There was a lot of disappointment."

Each of the organizations created has its own mission and tasks. The European Union's goal in creating the observation mission is to further strengthen its influence on Armenia and permanently "anchor" it here. At the same time, the main task of the representatives operating under the name of the EU observation mission deployed in Armenia is, first of all, to further expand and deepen relations with public, political, social and other spheres within the country. The fact that the mission is carrying out relevant work in these areas is welcomed by official Yerevan. Because the mission's activities are also anti-Russian in nature. So, the European Union, remaining true to its tradition, is playing a double-edged game. Armenia, on the other hand, is trying to achieve its own dirty goals in this game. But one day these games will end and official Yerevan will remain trapped in the middle of the plain. This will bring about a tragic end for Armenia.